

1 / 20 | Ages 7-8 | 20 minutes

Island symbols and map keys

What we are practising

Communicate a made-up place using consistent visual symbols.

What you need

Paper / Pencils

Describe a map aloud while a partner draws.

Before you begin

Choose an island name and draw its coastline.

Keep the island fictional; do not include a home address or private routes.

Try it together

1. Add four landmarks, such as a pond, hill, library and garden.
2. Invent one symbol per landmark and repeat the symbols in a map key.
3. Connect two places with a path and describe a journey along it.
4. Ask a partner to locate a place using only the key.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Which symbols are easy to confuse, and how could you change them?

Space to explore

2 / 20 | Ages 7-8 | 15 minutes

Rhythm conversation

What we are practising

Create, repeat and deliberately vary a rhythmic pattern.

What you need

No materials

Use silent hand gestures or spoken syllables instead of claps.

Before you begin

Agree on two gentle sounds, such as clap and knee tap.

Keep sounds comfortable, stop if anyone dislikes them and avoid striking objects or people.

Try it together

1. Make a four-beat pattern, for example clap, tap, tap, rest.
2. Have your partner repeat it, keeping the rest silent.
3. Swap roles and change just one beat.
4. Join the two patterns into an eight-beat conversation.

Talk, draw or show your idea

How does a rest change the pattern without adding a sound?

Space to explore

3 / 20 | Ages 7-8 | 20 minutes

A pattern that tiles

What we are practising

Use repetition and alignment to build a continuous pattern.

What you need

Paper / Pencil / Ruler if available

Fold the paper to make a grid instead of using a ruler.

Before you begin

Draw a grid of equal squares, at least three across and three down.

Draw on scrap paper; do not mark household surfaces.

Try it together

1. Draw the same simple motif in each square, such as a diagonal line.
2. Keep lines meeting at matching corners or edge midpoints.
3. Add a repeating two-symbol pattern to the squares.
4. Describe the smallest part that repeats.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Which features must line up for the pattern to continue?

Space to explore

4 / 20 | Ages 7-8 | 20 minutes

Folded characters on stage

What we are practising

Show character goals through words and actions.

What you need

Two sheets of paper / Pencils

Use hands as characters or draw them on one sheet.

Before you begin

Fold each sheet in half into a tent shape and draw a face on it.

Use fictional disagreements and allow a child to observe instead of perform.

Try it together

1. Give each character a different wish, such as reading quietly or singing.
2. Write or say two lines for each character explaining the wish.
3. Act out a meeting and invent a workable agreement.
4. Perform again with a different ending.

Talk, draw or show your idea

What agreement lets both characters do something they value?

Space to explore

5 / 20 | Ages 7-8 | 30 minutes

Design a pencil home

What we are practising

Design for a specific need and revise using a practical test.

What you need

Clean small box / Scrap paper / Tape / Three pencils

Draw the organizer and test a folded-paper divider in an existing box.

Before you begin

Choose a low stable box with no sharp staples or edges.

An adult checks reused packaging and handles any cutting; use no hot glue or sharp tools.

Try it together

1. List two needs, such as finding a pencil quickly and preventing rolling.
2. Sketch a design with folded-paper compartments.
3. Make one version with tape and place the pencils horizontally inside.
4. Test removing and replacing each pencil, then change one feature.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Which change made the organizer more useful?

Space to explore

6 / 20 | Ages 7-8 | 15 minutes

A symbol for the book exchange

What we are practising

Combine visual symbols to express an exchange.

What you need

Paper / Pencil

Describe or gesture your idea while a partner draws or writes.

Before you begin

Read the question aloud together. Use imagined people and places.

Keep examples fictional and participation voluntary; an adult can help read or act a role.

Try it together

1. Combine book and exchange clues into one compact symbol.
2. Show or say your first answer before reading the example.
3. Explain one choice, then try the extra challenge if you wish.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Design a symbol for a fictional book-exchange club. How could it suggest both books and exchange without using letters?

Space to explore

7 / 20 | Ages 7-8 | 15 minutes

Near trees, far trees

What we are practising

Use relative size and overlap to suggest distance.

What you need

Paper / Pencil

Describe or gesture your idea while a partner draws or writes.

Before you begin

Read the question aloud together. Use imagined people and places.

Keep examples fictional and participation voluntary; an adult can help read or act a role.

Try it together

1. Draw a forest using size and overlap to suggest distance.
2. Show or say your first answer before reading the example.
3. Explain one choice, then try the extra challenge if you wish.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Your stage drawing needs a forest that seems deep. How could you suggest near and far trees on one flat page?

Space to explore

8 / 20 | Ages 7-8 | 15 minutes

Show a long wait in one panel

What we are practising

Suggest elapsed time within a single still image.

What you need

Paper / Pencil

Describe or gesture your idea while a partner draws or writes.

Before you begin

Read the question aloud together. Use imagined people and places.

Keep examples fictional and participation voluntary; an adult can help read or act a role.

Try it together

1. Draw visual evidence of waiting in a fictional scene.
2. Show or say your first answer before reading the example.
3. Explain one choice, then try the extra challenge if you wish.

Talk, draw or show your idea

A comic character waits for a planted seed to sprout. What clues could show that time has passed without writing “later”?

Space to explore

9 / 20 | Ages 7-8 | 15 minutes

A character shown by belongings

What we are practising

Suggest a character's interests through selected belongings.

What you need

Paper / Pencil

Describe or gesture your idea while a partner draws or writes.

Before you begin

Read the question aloud together. Use imagined people and places.

Keep examples fictional and participation voluntary; an adult can help read or act a role.

Try it together

1. Draw three belongings and explain the character they suggest.
2. Show or say your first answer before reading the example.
3. Explain one choice, then try the extra challenge if you wish.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Invent a character who enjoys exploring but dislikes carrying heavy things. What three belongings would help suggest this?

Space to explore

10 / 20 | Ages 7-8 | 15 minutes

Three pieces become a machine

What we are practising

Assign connected functions to the parts of an imaginary machine.

What you need

Paper / Pencil

Describe or gesture your idea while a partner draws or writes.

Before you begin

Read the question aloud together. Use imagined people and places.

Keep examples fictional and participation voluntary; an adult can help read or act a role.

Try it together

1. Label the roles of three parts in an imaginary machine.
2. Show or say your first answer before reading the example.
3. Explain one choice, then try the extra challenge if you wish.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Invent a fictional machine using a funnel, a wheel and a box. What does each part do in your imagined design?

Space to explore

11 / 20 | Ages 7-8 | 15 minutes

A recognisable silhouette

What we are practising

Identify which outer shape makes an object recognisable.

What you need

Paper / Pencil

Describe or gesture your idea while a partner draws or writes.

Before you begin

Read the question aloud together. Use imagined people and places.

Keep examples fictional and participation voluntary; an adult can help read or act a role.

Try it together

1. Draw an animal outline and test recognition without interior marks.
2. Show or say your first answer before reading the example.
3. Explain one choice, then try the extra challenge if you wish.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Design a fictional animal mascot that remains recognisable as a single dark outline. Which features matter most?

Space to explore

12 / 20 | Ages 7-8 | 15 minutes

Clues for a story treasure

What we are practising

Place a story clue where it supports a fair search.

What you need

Paper / Pencil

Describe or gesture your idea while a partner draws or writes.

Before you begin

Read the question aloud together. Use imagined people and places.

Keep examples fictional and participation voluntary; an adult can help read or act a role.

Try it together

1. Design a map detail that makes two story clues usable.
2. Show or say your first answer before reading the example.
3. Explain one choice, then try the extra challenge if you wish.

Talk, draw or show your idea

On an invented map, treasure is near a bridge but not near the only tree. What visible detail could help a reader find the intended spot?

Space to explore

13 / 20 | Ages 7-8 | 15 minutes

A word that looks like its meaning

What we are practising

Use expressive lettering while preserving a word's readability.

What you need

Paper / Pencil

Describe or gesture your idea while a partner draws or writes.

Before you begin

Read the question aloud together. Use imagined people and places.

Keep examples fictional and participation voluntary; an adult can help read or act a role.

Try it together

1. Draw a word whose visual treatment suggests its meaning.
2. Show or say your first answer before reading the example.
3. Explain one choice, then try the extra challenge if you wish.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Write the word “stretch” so its appearance suggests stretching. How can you change its shape or setting while keeping it readable?

Space to explore

14 / 20 | Ages 7-8 | 15 minutes

A cover that invites curiosity

What we are practising

Design a cover that raises a question without revealing the ending.

What you need

Paper / Pencil

Describe or gesture your idea while a partner draws or writes.

Before you begin

Read the question aloud together. Use imagined people and places.

Keep examples fictional and participation voluntary; an adult can help read or act a role.

Try it together

1. Design a fictional book cover that hints at a mystery.
2. Show or say your first answer before reading the example.
3. Explain one choice, then try the extra challenge if you wish.

Talk, draw or show your idea

A story is about a key found in a garden. How could its cover make readers curious without showing what the key opens?

Space to explore

15 / 20 | Ages 7-8 | 15 minutes

Two titles for one image

What we are practising

Compare how titles change the interpretation of one image.

What you need

Paper / Pencil

Describe or gesture your idea while a partner draws or writes.

Before you begin

Read the question aloud together. Use imagined people and places.

Keep examples fictional and participation voluntary; an adult can help read or act a role.

Try it together

1. Give one simple image two contrasting story titles.
2. Show or say your first answer before reading the example.
3. Explain one choice, then try the extra challenge if you wish.

Talk, draw or show your idea

A picture shows an empty chair under a tree. How might two different titles lead readers to imagine different stories?

Space to explore

16 / 20 | Ages 7-8 | 15 minutes

Packaging that becomes play

What we are practising

Plan a second playful use for a familiar package.

What you need

Paper / Pencil

Describe or gesture your idea while a partner draws or writes.

Before you begin

Read the question aloud together. Use imagined people and places.

Keep examples fictional and participation voluntary; an adult can help read or act a role.

Try it together

1. Sketch a box surface with a useful second purpose.
2. Show or say your first answer before reading the example.
3. Explain one choice, then try the extra challenge if you wish.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Design a pretend toy box whose picture can be reused as a game board after opening. What should appear on it?

Space to explore

17 / 20 | Ages 7-8 | 15 minutes

A different picture through a frame

What we are practising

Change a picture's emphasis by choosing what the frame includes.

What you need

Paper / Pencil

Describe or gesture your idea while a partner draws or writes.

Before you begin

Read the question aloud together. Use imagined people and places.

Keep examples fictional and participation voluntary; an adult can help read or act a role.

Try it together

1. Draw a frame inside a scene to change its focus.
2. Show or say your first answer before reading the example.
3. Explain one choice, then try the extra challenge if you wish.

Talk, draw or show your idea

A large drawing shows a market and one dropped apple. What would you include in a smaller frame to make the apple the main story?

Space to explore

18 / 20 | Ages 7-8 | 15 minutes

Three frames of one jump

What we are practising

Keep a moving object recognisable across a short image sequence.

What you need

Paper / Pencil

Describe or gesture your idea while a partner draws or writes.

Before you begin

Read the question aloud together. Use imagined people and places.

Keep examples fictional and participation voluntary; an adult can help read or act a role.

Try it together

1. Draw three positions of one recognisable moving object.
2. Show or say your first answer before reading the example.
3. Explain one choice, then try the extra challenge if you wish.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Draw a pretend ball before, during and after a bounce. What should stay the same so it looks like the same ball?

Space to explore

19 / 20 | Ages 7-8 | 15 minutes

A costume described by function

What we are practising

Use costume details to communicate a fictional role.

What you need

Paper / Pencil

Describe or gesture your idea while a partner draws or writes.

Before you begin

Read the question aloud together. Use imagined people and places.

Keep examples fictional and participation voluntary; an adult can help read or act a role.

Try it together

1. Design a fictional costume with two job-related details.
2. Show or say your first answer before reading the example.
3. Explain one choice, then try the extra challenge if you wish.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Invent a costume for a fictional messenger who carries pictures between clouds. Which details explain the job without writing its name?

Space to explore

20 / 20 | Ages 7-8 | 15 minutes

Which bubble belongs to whom?

What we are practising

Make speakers and reading order clear in a comic panel.

What you need

Paper / Pencil

Describe or gesture your idea while a partner draws or writes.

Before you begin

Read the question aloud together. Use imagined people and places.

Keep examples fictional and participation voluntary; an adult can help read or act a role.

Try it together

1. Arrange two dialogue bubbles for two clearly identified speakers.
2. Show or say your first answer before reading the example.
3. Explain one choice, then try the extra challenge if you wish.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Two comic characters speak in the same panel. How can the drawing show who says each sentence without using their names?

Space to explore

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

1. Island symbols and map keys

A little hint

Give each symbol a distinct shape, not only a different colour.

Answer / what to notice

Many maps work if symbols are used consistently and the key explains them.

A map simplifies a place so useful information can be found quickly.

Make it easier

Use three landmarks with picture symbols.

Take it further

Add a scale such as one grid square equals ten imaginary steps.

Another day, away from the screen

Create a treasure clue that relies on two map landmarks.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

2. Rhythm conversation

A little hint

Count four evenly spaced beats, including the quiet one.

Answer / what to notice

Any repeatable sequence works; the partner should preserve both sounds and rests.

Rhythm includes the timing of silence as well as sound.

Make it easier

Use a two-beat call and response.

Take it further

Keep the same rhythm but change which gentle sounds produce it.

Another day, away from the screen

Give a familiar poem a gentle repeating beat.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

3. A pattern that tiles

A little hint

Choose the same starting and ending positions on each square.

Answer / what to notice

Many designs work; equal squares cover a region without gaps, and matching edges make the motif continuous.

Repeating one small unit can create a larger organized design.

Make it easier

Decorate a row of four squares.

Take it further

Rotate alternate motifs and predict the new larger pattern.

Another day, away from the screen

Look for repeating units in tiles, fabrics or book covers.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

4. Folded characters on stage

A little hint

They could choose different spaces or take turns.

Answer / what to notice

Possible endings include separate spaces or agreed turns; explain how both characters are heard.

Dialogue becomes clearer when the audience understands what each character wants.

Make it easier

An adult voices one character and models a request.

Take it further

Add a narrator who summarizes without taking sides.

Another day, away from the screen

Make a small theatre programme with the title and characters.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

5. Design a pencil home

A little hint

A divider that looks good may still be too narrow for a pencil.

Answer / what to notice

A successful organizer meets the chosen needs, stays stable and lets pencils be taken out easily.

Testing reveals practical problems that a drawing can miss.

Make it easier

Decorate and label an existing compartment.

Take it further

Design a removable divider and compare two arrangements.

Another day, away from the screen

Use the organizer for a day and note one possible improvement.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

6. A symbol for the book exchange

A little hint

Choose one cue for the object and one for the action.

Answer / what to notice

Example answer: An open book between two curved arrows could suggest books moving between readers. Other reasoned ideas can work.

Combining two visual ideas can communicate a specific purpose.

Make it easier

Start with a book drawing and add one exchange clue.

Take it further

Test a very small version and remove a detail that becomes unclear.

Another day, away from the screen

Keep your drawing and ask a partner to invent a different solution to the same question.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

7. Near trees, far trees

A little hint

Which tree hides part of another?

Answer / what to notice

Example answer: I draw larger overlapping trees near the bottom and smaller trees behind them. Other reasoned ideas can work.

Relative size and overlap can suggest depth in a flat image.

Make it easier

Compare one large tree with one small tree.

Take it further

Show a winding path becoming narrower in the distance.

Another day, away from the screen

Keep your drawing and ask a partner to invent a different solution to the same question.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

8. Show a long wait in one panel

A little hint

Choose a clue that changes over time.

Answer / what to notice

Example answer: Changing sunlight and several crossed-off calendar boxes could suggest passing days. Other reasoned ideas can work.

Visual clues can imply elapsed time beyond the action shown.

Make it easier

Use two pictures with different sun positions.

Take it further

Explain why your clues suggest time but not an exact duration.

Another day, away from the screen

Keep your drawing and ask a partner to invent a different solution to the same question.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

9. A character shown by belongings

A little hint

Link each belonging to one part of the character description.

Answer / what to notice

Example answer: A folded map, a small notebook and a light bag could fit the character. Other reasoned ideas can work.

Selected props can imply interests and practical preferences without explaining everything.

Make it easier

Choose two of these imagined belongings: a light map, a tiny notebook, or a heavy stone.

Take it further

Add an unexpected belonging and invent a plausible reason for it.

Another day, away from the screen

Keep your drawing and ask a partner to invent a different solution to the same question.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

10. Three pieces become a machine

A little hint

Explain where something enters, changes and leaves or stays.

Answer / what to notice

Example answer: My story machine takes paper ideas through the funnel, turns the wheel and stores sorted stories in the box. Other reasoned ideas can work.

Assigning roles connects separate parts into a coherent invention.

Make it easier

Use two parts and one simple job.

Take it further

Identify one part that would need a real mechanism if built.

Another day, away from the screen

Keep your drawing and ask a partner to invent a different solution to the same question.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

11. A recognisable silhouette

A little hint

Imagine filling every inside detail with the same colour.

Answer / what to notice

Example answer: A long curved tail and two large pointed ears could distinguish it without face details. Other reasoned ideas can work.

A silhouette communicates outer shape while hiding interior detail.

Make it easier

Choose one distinctive outer feature to exaggerate.

Take it further

Make two mascots with clearly different silhouettes.

Another day, away from the screen

Keep your drawing and ask a partner to invent a different solution to the same question.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

12. Clues for a story treasure

A little hint

Make both possible bridge ends visible.

Answer / what to notice

Example answer: I draw two bridge ends, place the tree beside one, and mark the treasure near the other. Other reasoned ideas can work.

A clue works when the drawing contains the distinctions needed to use it.

Make it easier

Use a bridge and just one clearly marked hiding place.

Take it further

Test whether another spot also fits and refine the clue.

Another day, away from the screen

Keep your drawing and ask a partner to invent a different solution to the same question.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

13. A word that looks like its meaning

A little hint

You can change size and background rather than break letters apart.

Answer / what to notice

Example answer: I draw wider letter shapes or a stretched background while keeping the word readable. Other reasoned ideas can work.

Expressive lettering should support meaning without destroying the written word.

Make it easier

An adult writes the word; add a background that suggests stretching.

Take it further

Try “whisper” and explain a different visual choice.

Another day, away from the screen

If both languages are familiar, compare your idea with the Arabic word «ددمت» while keeping its letter connections correct.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

14. A cover that invites curiosity

A little hint

Show the discovery, not the final door.

Answer / what to notice

Example answer: A half-hidden key among leaves and a questioning title could invite a guess. Other reasoned ideas can work.

A cover can reveal the central mystery while withholding its solution.

Make it easier

Choose one object to place on the cover.

Take it further

Explain which detail you deliberately kept hidden.

Another day, away from the screen

Keep your drawing and ask a partner to invent a different solution to the same question.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

15. Two titles for one image

A little hint

Keep the image fixed and change the suggested event.

Answer / what to notice

Example answer: “Waiting for a Friend” suggests an arrival; “The Chair That Escaped” suggests an adventure. Other reasoned ideas can work.

A title supplies context that can change interpretation without changing the picture.

Make it easier

Choose which of two titles suggests an adventure.

Take it further

Invent a third title that remains plausible from the picture.

Another day, away from the screen

Keep your drawing and ask a partner to invent a different solution to the same question.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

16. Packaging that becomes play

A little hint

Think about what stays visible when the box is flattened.

Answer / what to notice

Example answer: A clear path with start and finish could turn the flattened box picture into a game board. Other reasoned ideas can work.

Planning a second use can influence the first design.

Make it easier

Draw only the flat game-board face.

Take it further

Keep essential game markings away from imagined folds.

Another day, away from the screen

Keep your drawing and ask a partner to invent a different solution to the same question.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

17. A different picture through a frame

A little hint

Keep enough context to understand the action.

Answer / what to notice

Example answer: I include the apple, a reaching hand and a small part of the stall, leaving out distant shoppers. Other reasoned ideas can work.

Cropping changes attention by selecting which context remains visible.

Make it easier

Choose between two adult-drawn frames.

Take it further

Make a second crop that tells a different plausible story.

Another day, away from the screen

Keep your drawing and ask a partner to invent a different solution to the same question.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

18. Three frames of one jump

A little hint

Choose one mark that appears in every frame.

Answer / what to notice

Example answer: Its stripe and overall size stay recognisable while its height changes. Other reasoned ideas can work.

Consistent identifying details connect an object across successive images.

Make it easier

Use two positions with the same stripe.

Take it further

Add a fourth frame and keep the movement sequence coherent.

Another day, away from the screen

Keep your drawing and ask a partner to invent a different solution to the same question.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

19. A costume described by function

A little hint

Show something the character needs for the task.

Answer / what to notice

Example answer: Flat picture pockets and cloud-shaped travel badges suggest what the messenger carries and where they go. Other reasoned ideas can work.

Costume details can reveal a role through function and setting.

Make it easier

Add one useful pocket to a simple outline.

Take it further

Remove one decoration and explain whether the role is still clear.

Another day, away from the screen

Keep your drawing and ask a partner to invent a different solution to the same question.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

20. Which bubble belongs to whom?

A little hint

Use right-to-left order for Arabic dialogue and left-to-right for English.

Answer / what to notice

Example answer: Speech-bubble tails can point toward the speakers, with the first bubble placed in the intended reading order. Other reasoned ideas can work.

Layout and connecting marks clarify speaker and sequence.

Make it easier

Add one bubble tail to one character.

Take it further

Add a reply and ask a reader to follow the full exchange.

Another day, away from the screen

Keep your drawing and ask a partner to invent a different solution to the same question.